

Simplified Motion Offense for Youth Basketball

Benefits:

1. Constant motion for all five players.
2. Typically generates great post looks.
3. Typically leads to great isolation on top.

Spacing

- This is the single most important concept of any offense.
- Spread the floor – compact offenses make it easier for defenders to guard more than one player. For example, put all your players around the NBA 3-point line.
- If running a double low post offense, move both post players off and below the blocks for better spacing.

Communication

- For an offense to be effective, players have to talk.
- One way to foster good communication on offense is to have the offense and defense wear the same color shirts in practice.

Ball Reversal

- The pattern is side – top – side.
- The defense is usually able to recover after one pass. So reverse the ball once for a good shot and reverse it twice for a great shot. (See the Reverse the Ball Drill)

Pass & Cut (Move, Move, Move)

- Stationary players are easy to guard. That's why players should always cut after making a pass. (See the Pass and Cut Drill.)

Shot Selection

- Players must know their shooting range and stay within it.

BONUS TIP: KISS – Keep It Simple, Stupid

- Your offense won't be effective if your players are confused all the time – so keep it simple.

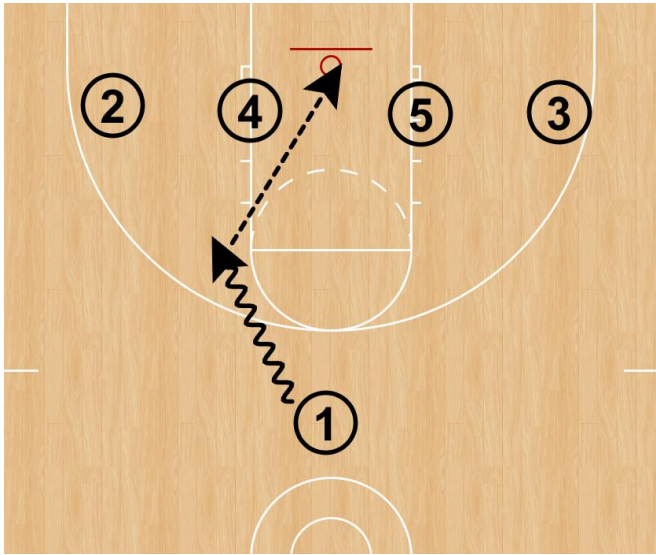
Motion Offense – Flat Top

Purpose

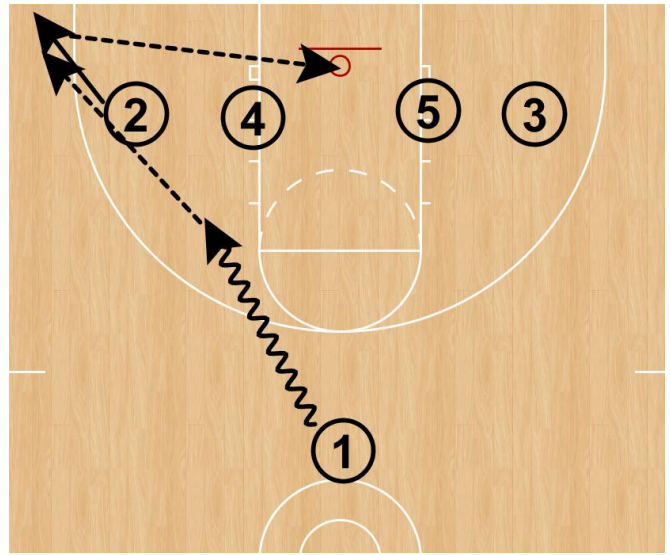
- Isolates the point guard to go one on one.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, the other four players line up across the bottom of the formation.



1 works for his own shot.



If the defense collapses, 1 finds the open man.

Execution

1. 1 takes his man one-on-one and works to get an open shot.
2. If help comes, the man whose defender left, cuts to receive the pass from 1 and takes the shot.

Coaching Tips

- You can put any player at the 1 position – in the motion offense all players should be able to play all positions.

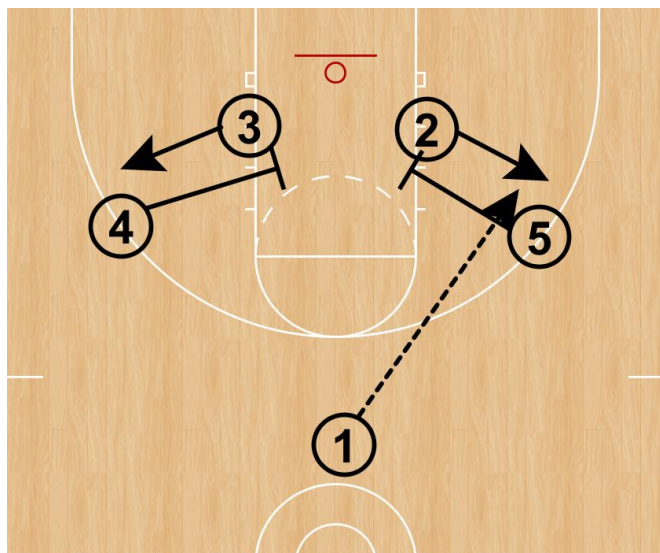
Motion Offense – The Gate

Purpose

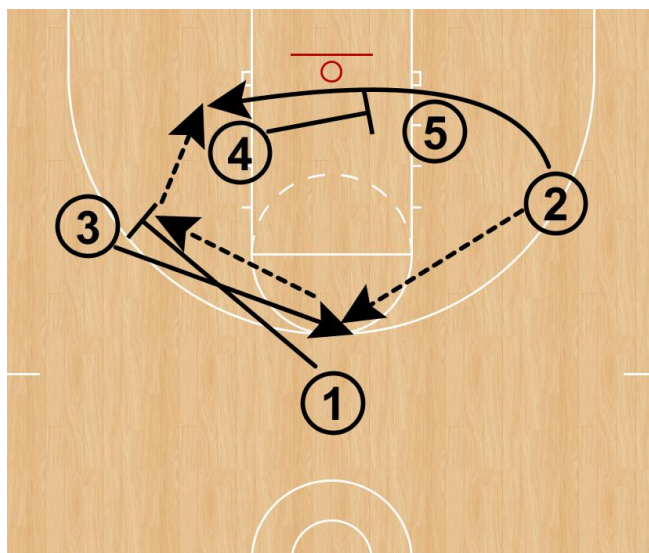
- Keeps players in motion to stress the defense and generate open looks.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2 and 3 are on the blocks, 4 and 5 are on the wings.



On the initial action, 2 looks for 5 in the post.



If 5 isn't open, the players reverse the ball to the opposite side.

Execution

- 4 and 5 pick down with 2 and 3 running out to the wings.
- 1 passes to 2 who first looks at 5 in the post.
- 1 runs over and screens for 3 who flashes to the top of the key.
- 2 passes to 3 and then 2 runs off screens from 5 and 4 to the post.
- 3 passes to 1 who passes to 2 in the post.
- Motion repeats until a shot is taken.

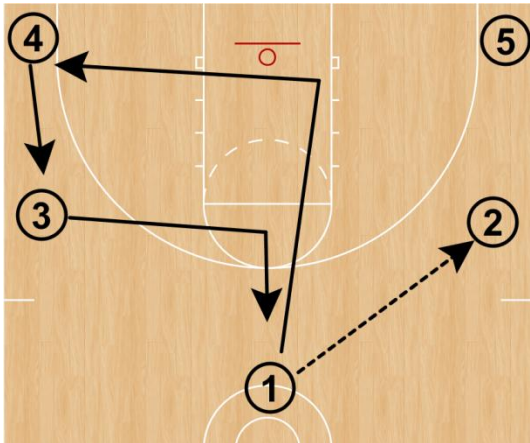
Coaching Tips

- If the wing is passing to the post, he should use a wraparound pass or a bowling pass (roll the ball). He should not use the two hand over the head pass (it's too easy to pick off).
- Make sure players stay in motion. They should be passing and moving – cutting hard to create open offensive opportunities.
- Practice the offense by having five players run the motion continuously for 30 seconds, then sub in a new five.

Motion Offense – Five Man Motion

Purpose

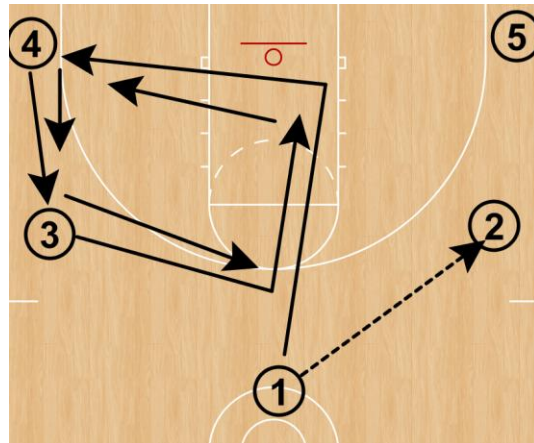
- This offense spreads the floor and keeps offensive players in motion.



On the initial action, 1 passes to 2 and makes a basket cut.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2 and 3 are on the wings, 4 and 5 are in the corners.



Motion Drop features back to back cutters to throw the defense off.

Execution

- Rule 1** – If a player is being overplayed by a defender, he should go back door. If he doesn't receive a pass he continues through to the opposite corner and the players above all rotate over to fill his spot.
- Rule 2** – If a player at the top passes to the wing, he makes a basket cut. If he doesn't receive the ball he goes to the corner and the players rotate to fill his spot.
- Rule 3** – If a wing player passes to the hoop, he makes a basket cut and goes to the same side corner. The corner moves up to the wing.
- Rule 4** – If a wing passes to the corner, the wing sets a pick for the corner player and then rolls to the basket. Everyone else rotates to fill.
- Motion Drop** – With this version of the offense, on the pass from the top to the wing not only does the first guy basket cut but also the guy taking his place immediately basket cuts as well. So there are two cutters.
- Motion Pick** – 1 passes to the wing and sets a screen for the opposite wing, who basket cuts. If the wing doesn't receive the pass he goes to same side corner, the corner moves up to the wing and 1 flashes back to the top. 1 can also pick for baseline players. Then the opposite wing would move to the top to fill and everyone else would rotate.

Coaching Tips

- This is a good offense to run against a team with a pressure defense. It is also a good choice if you do not have a dominant post player.
- Be sure to space the floor – having good spacing is key. That means your players should be set up out wide not in close to the basket.
- The point guard always has the option of driving into the paint if he can.

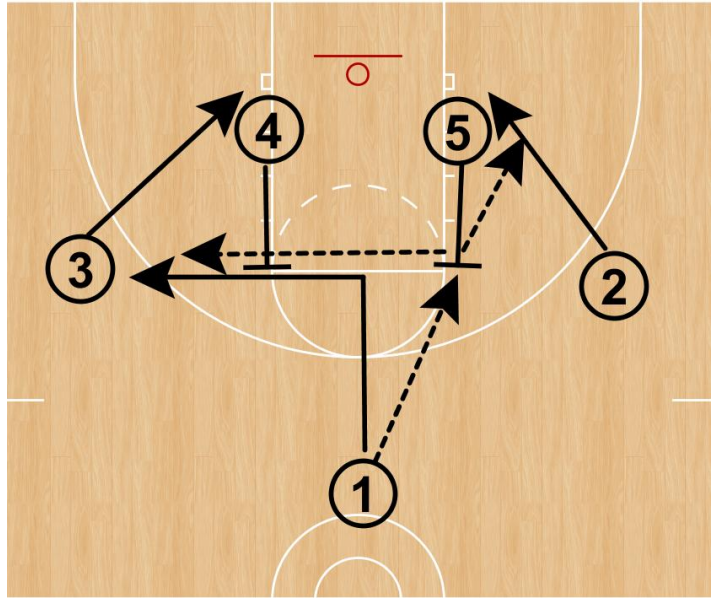
Motion Offense – Stanford Special Play

Purpose

- Provides back door looks as well as a potential jump shot or drive from the wing.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2 and 3 are on the wings, 4 and 5 are in a double low post.



4 and 5 flash and 2 and 3 go back door.

Execution

1. 4 and 5 flash to the high post. 2 and 3 go back door.
2. If ball is passed to 5, he looks for 2 going back door. If that is not there he has 1 coming off a screen from 4 and going to the wing.

Coaching Tips

- 1 needs to take his defender down to the free throw line so he can run him off the pick.
- Screeners should be setting solid wide picks and 1 should be running tight off the screener's shoulder so the defender can't get through.

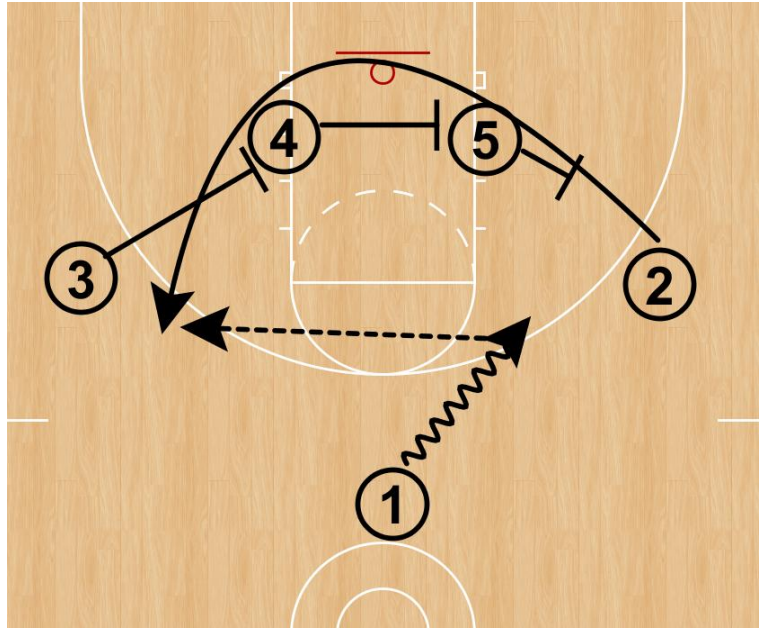
Motion Offense – America's Play

Purpose

- Generates a good look for your best shooter.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2 and 3 are on the wings, 4 and 5 are in a double low post.



2 runs off three picks to get open for the 3-pointer.

Execution

1. 2 runs off a triple pick from 5, 4 and 3 to get an open look at a 3-pointer on the wing.

Coaching Tips

- 2 needs to move fast and look to rub shoulders with each picker as he goes by to lose the defenders.
- 1 should offset and dribble over slightly to the side opposite where 2 is going to clear even more room for him.

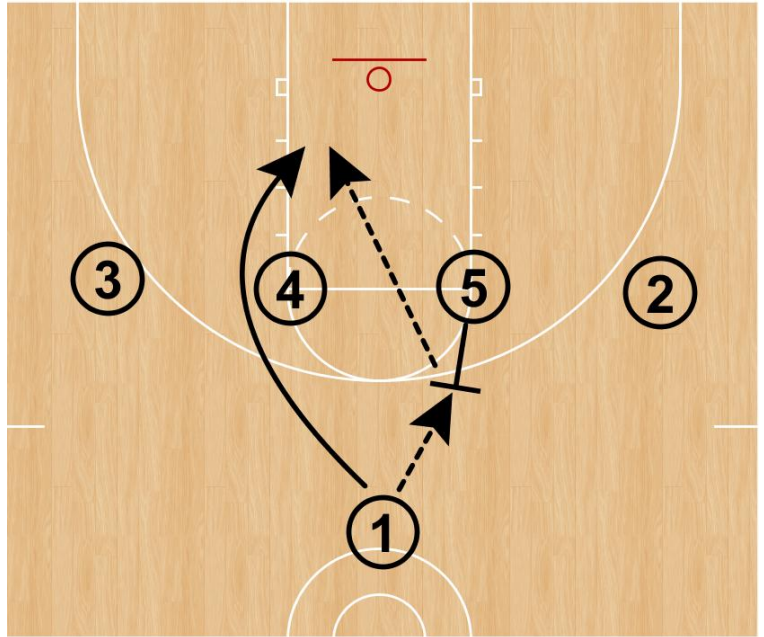
Motion Offense – Lobster Special Play

Purpose

- Creates a back door opportunity.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2, 3, 4 and 5 are lined up along the free throw line extended.



1 goes back door off a screen from 4.

Execution

1. 5 pops out and receives the pass from 1.
2. 1 cuts off a screen from 4 and goes back door for the lob from 5.

Coaching Tips

- This is a great play if you have a big kid who you want to isolate down low. When executed properly, it can really get the crowd into the game.

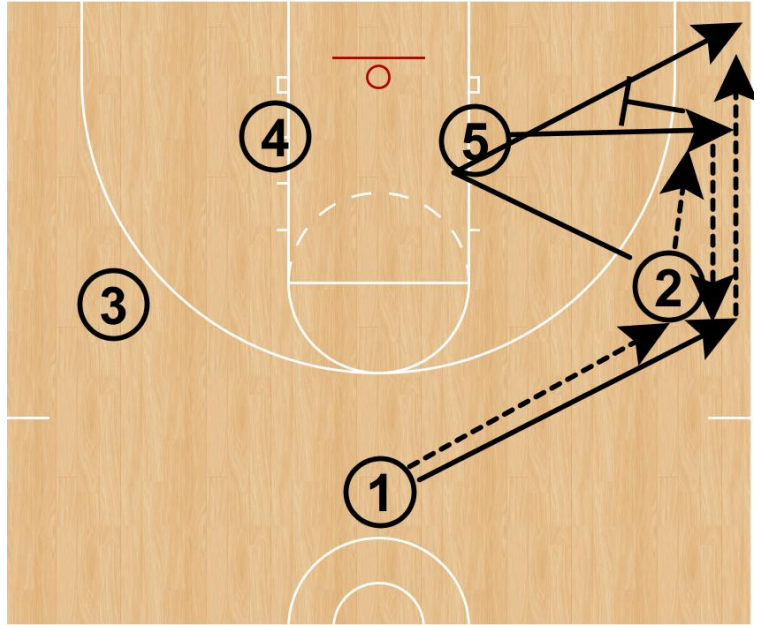
Motion Offense – Yankee Special Play

Purpose

- Frees 2 for a corner jumper.

Setup

- 1 is at the top, 2 and 3 on the wings, 4 and 5 are the double low post.



2 runs off a pick from 5 to get open for the corner jumper.

Execution

1. 1 passes to 2 who passes to the corner to 5.
2. 2 cuts to the basket and 1 moves to the wing to 2's old position.
3. 5 passes to 1. Then 5 moves forward and screens for 2.
4. 2 cuts off the screen to the corner. He receives the pass from 1 and shoots.

Coaching Tips

- This is a nice little side action that can clear a good shooter for an open look.
- 2 shouldn't go too deep on his basket cut – he should stop at the block.